

Speech Assessment Reading Passage

Section I: Standardized Continuous Speech Passages

Instructions for Patient

Read the following passages aloud in your normal speaking voice. Maintain a natural, comfortable pace. Try to read without stopping, even if you stumble or repeat words.

1. The Grandfather Passage

You wish to know all about my grandfather. Well, he is nearly ninety-three years old. He limits his spoon to three bites of food, yet he still thinks as swiftly as ever. A long, flowing beard clings to his chin, giving those who observe him a pronounced feeling of the utmost respect. When he speaks, his voice is just a bit cracked and quivers a trifle. In a double wooden box, he keeps an old, rusty knife which he uses to shave his grandfather's plug tobacco. Every day he plays a short round of golf on the links near the house. We have often urged him to walk more and play less, but he only nods his head and smiles. He is a grandfather we all love dearly.

2. The Rainbow Passage

When the sunlight strikes raindrops in the air, they act as a prism and form a rainbow. The rainbow is a division of white light into many beautiful colors. These take the shape of a long round arch, with its path high above, and its two ends apparently beyond the horizon. There is, according to legend, a boiling pot of gold at one end. People look, but no one ever finds it. When a man looks for something beyond his reach, his friends say he is looking for the pot of gold at the end of the rainbow.